



and abduct the princess' castle itself, zooming off into space.

To follow them, Mario takes the help of 'lumas', a species of star-like creature that is stranded on their spaceship, the Comet Observatory, because Bowser stole all their Power Stars. These Power Stars are the fuel for the spaceship and your mission, obviously, is going to be tracking down and retrieving all of them so that you can use the Comet Observatory to then reach Bowser's hideout and rescue the princess.

Each of these Power Stars is hidden away on a planet in a far-away galaxy, where the rules of gravity are not quite the same as on Earth. In some places, you will find yourself jumping up and suddenly landing feet-first on the ceiling, and then continuing walking on that platform. In others, you will be able to walk all around a sphere and jump on to the next one, almost as if your shoes had sticky soles. Want to try jumping from one platform to the other? Good luck trying, because the orientation of gravity will suddenly change mid-jump and you will land on a completely different side of the screen. It's an incredible amount of fun, although some camera angles and rapid movements can make you a bit nauseous.

Of course, the WiiMote plays a big role throughout all of this. Mario's default attack mode is activated by shaking the controller at an enemy – a neat twist on the standard 'jump on his back' technique. And some mini-games harness the motion-sensing capabilities of the Wii, making you perform antics such as balancing yourself as Mario tries not to roll off a giant boulder.

The game also throws in a bit of the classic *Super Mario Bros 3*: the Mario suits are back! A honeybee suit will let you fly around, while an invisibility cloak lets you hide from enemies. There's the authentic firefly suit to throw fireballs, another that lets you freeze liquid to walk on it and a spring suit to reach high platforms.

The cool graphics easily make this the best-looking Mario game in history and a brilliant soundtrack offers remixes of some of the popular Mario themes and tunes.

We cannot stress this enough: if you buy a Wii, you have to buy Super Mario Galaxy with it. Treat this not as a suggestion, but more a directive from higher powers.